

Jan-Willem Simons

Academic Curriculum Vitae in August 2026

j.g.simons@uu.nl | [ORCID](#) | [Website](#) | [LinkedIn](#) | [Github](#)

INTERESTS	Interethnic attitudes and behaviours; Socialisation effects; Media effects; Social influence; Social norms; Negative social relations; Systematic reviews and meta-analyses; Agent-based models; Social Network Analysis; Exponential random graph models; Hidden Markov models	
EDUCATION	Utrecht University , The Netherlands	Expected September 2026
	PhD Student in Sociology	
	Thesis (working title): <i>Social Influences as Determinants of and Pathways for Changing Interethnic Relations: Evidence from Systematic Reviews, Agent-Based Modelling, and Social Network Experiments</i>	
	Advisors: Prof. Dr. Eva Jaspers (University of Utrecht) and Prof Dr. Frank van Tubergen (University of Utrecht)	
	Utrecht University , The Netherlands	July 2021
PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS	M.Sc. in Methodology and Statistics for the Behavioural, Biomedical, and Social Sciences	
	Thesis: <i>On the Analysis of a Sample of Exponential Random Graph Model Estimates</i>	
	Advisor: Prof. Dr. Marijtje van Duijn (University of Groningen)	
	Utrecht University , The Netherlands	July 2019
	B.Sc. in Sociology with a Minor in Methods and Statistics	
PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS	Thesis: <i>Examining the Effect of Observation Sequence Variables on Hidden Markov Model Gibbs Sampler Inference</i>	
	Advisor: Dr. Emmeke Aarts (University of Utrecht)	
	Additional Activities: Honours College Faculty of Social Sciences	
	[7] Schäfer, L., F., Tausch, N., Bukowski, M., Jaspers, E., Lubbers, M., J., Van Zalk, M., Ciorda, A., Potoczek, A., Estevan-Reina, L., Shani, M., Simons, J.-W. , Friehs, M., T., Gurbisz, D., Middendorf, W., M., Schäfer, S., J., Ullenboom, J., Graf, S., Hjerm, M., Lavest, C., Jasinskaja-Lahti, I., Kende, A., Petkanopoulou, K., Prati, F., & Christ, O. (2026). Associations between inclusivity norms and tolerance, contact, and cooperation amid polarization: Evidence from 12 European countries. <i>PNAS Nexus</i> , pgag087. https://doi.org/10.1093/pnasnexus/pgag087	
	[6] Simons, J.-W. , Jaspers, E., & van Tubergen, F. (2026). Media influences on ethnic majority attitudes toward ethnic minorities: A systematic review and meta-analysis. <i>International Journal of Intercultural Relations</i> , 110, Article 102320. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijintrel.2025.102320	
	[5] Heo, I., Simons, J.-W. , & Liu, H. (2025). A tutorial on Bayesian model averaging for exponential random graph models. <i>British Journal of Mathematical and Statistical Psychology</i> . https://doi.org/10.1111/bmsp.70007	
	[4] Jaspers, E., Van Zantvliet, P. I., & Simons, J.-W. (2025). How Descriptive Norms and Peer Attitudes Shape Interethnic Dating Among Adolescents in Dutch Schools. <i>Social Inclusion</i> , 13. https://doi.org/10.17645/si.10034	
	[3] Simons, J.-W. , Jaspers, E., & van Tubergen, F. (2025). Socialisation and ethnic majorities' attitudes towards ethnic minorities: a systematic review and meta-analysis of correlational evidence. <i>Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies</i> , 51(11), 2669–2694. https://doi.org/10.1080/1369183X.2025.2472818	
	[2] Simons, J.-W. , Boverhof, B.-J., & Aarts, E. (2024). The influence of observation sequence features on the performance of the Bayesian hidden Markov model: A Monte Carlo simulation study. <i>PloS One</i> , 19(12), e0314444. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0314444	

- [1] Goossens, C., & **Simons, J.-W.** (2024). Overbruggen van denkbeelden en grenzen: De effecten van opleidingsniveau op anti-immigratie attitudes in West-en Oost-Europa. *Mens & Maatschappij*, 99(1), 33-61. <https://doi.org/10.5117/MEM2024.1.003.GOOS>

PREPRINTS

- [1] Ciorda, A., Lubbers, M., Jaspers, E., & **Simons, J.-W.** (2025). Not All Political Topics Are Created Equal: How Issue Polarization Shapes Partner Selection in Informal Political Discussion. https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/zauq4_v1

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- [5] Heo, I. (presenter), **Simons, J.-W.**, & Liu, H. *A Bayesian multi-model inferential approach to exponential random graph modeling* [Poster Presentation]. 133rd Annual Convention of the American Psychological Association. Denver, The United States of America. August, 2025.
- [4] **Simons, J.-W.** (presenter), Tolsma, J., Jaspers, E. *On the Design of a Social Norm Intervention to Promote Interethnic Cooperation through Tolerance: An Agent-Based Model* [Conference Presentation]. 5th ISA Forum of Sociology. Rabat, Morocco. July, 2025.
- [3] **Simons, J.-W.** (presenter), Tolsma, J., Jaspers, E. *On the Design of a Social Norm Intervention to Promote Interethnic Cooperation through Tolerance: An Agent-Based Model* [Conference Presentation]. Interdisciplinary Conference on Social Norms, Cohesion, and (De)Polarization. Utrecht, The Netherlands. May, 2025.
- [2] **Simons, J.-W.** (presenter), Jaspers, E. *Balance, Status, and Negative Tie Dynamics in A High Proximity Network Context* [Conference Presentation]. European Conference of Social Networks. Ljubljana, Slovenia. September, 2023.
- [1] **Simons, J.-W.** (presenter), Van Duijn, M. A. J. *On the Analysis of a Sample of Exponential Random Graph Model Estimates* [Conference Presentation]. European Conference of Social Networks. Online. September, 2021.

RESEARCH VISITS **Autonomous University of Barcelona**
Visiting PhD Researcher, COALESCE Lab
Collaborator: Professor Miranda Lubbers

Barcelona, Spain
April – July 2023

SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

Ad-hoc Peer Review
PLOS ONE (2 reviews for 1 manuscript, 2025-2026)
Social Sciences & Humanities Open (1 review for 1 manuscript, 2026)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Tutorial group teaching October 2021 – October 2024
Department of Sociology, Utrecht University
Activities: Taught a tutorial group each second semester from 2021 to 2024 for the course "Social Networks in Theory and Empirical Research".

Bachelor thesis supervision October 2022 – October 2025
Department of Sociology, Utrecht University
Activities: Supervised groups of 3–5 sociology bachelor's students in writing their thesis projects during the second semester of the academic years 2022–2025.

SKILLS AND PROFICIENCIES

Statistical Software
R (RStudio, Markdown, Shiny), NetLogo, Python, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Git, *Mplus*, SPSS

Language Ability
Native in Dutch, Near native in English, Beginner in French and German